



Teaching innovation in university education: Case studies and main practices

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BOOK REVIEW

Teaching innovation in university education: Case studies and main practices, edited by Jose Ramon Saura, Hershey, PA, IGI Global, 2022, 330 pp., \$165 (paperback), ISBN 9781668444412

Innovation in teaching and learning is very much evident at all stages of education, from initial schooling to higher education worldwide. However, in the last decade, teaching innovation has become a significant feature in the education industry because of the growth and expansion of the latest technologies that have made innovation an essential pillar of education (Ozfidan et al., 2021). Jose Saura, in this *Teaching Innovation in University Education* book, includes a comprehensive discussion on teaching innovation that evaluates both learning and teaching models to drive advances in technologies used in the education system. This is the first book of its kind that describes the comprehension and understanding of various teaching models and technologies developed in the academic sector. Therefore, this book evaluates the teaching innovation process that tracks validation in the teaching and academic communities at higher education institutes to promote the uses of innovation for future studies as well as improvement and its practices through data-based and digital development methods. The author composed this book as a significant source for everyone related to higher education, such as administrators, researchers, teachers, students, and academicians, focusing on the critical topics of technology-based learning, didactic strategies, and service learning.

This book is divided into two sections. Section 1 contains four chapters, and these chapters discuss the primary contributions that highlight teaching innovation methodologies and analysis of the process applied in higher education, particularly at the university level. Section 2 contains 11 chapters, and these chapters discuss various case studies that analyze the implementation of teaching innovation practices in higher education institutes. This section further presents a comprehensive case studies analysis where teaching innovation has been applied to different academic themes and subjects. In short, both sections are dedicated to the primary practices in teaching innovation and case studies in university education developed in the last decades at higher education institutes, particularly universities. It covers the development of technologies and their identification, as well as teaching innovation methodologies through case studies. This identification practice will be helpful in promoting the development of practices and initiatives focused on implementing teaching innovation in university education (Ibrahim, 2018).

As Saura emphasizes in this book, teaching innovation has become a significant factor in higher education, where innovation drives the adaptation of new technologies and teaching methods (Abdullah & Amroun, 2017; Saura et al., 2022). Therefore, teaching and innovation must be combined as themes, methods, and concepts that collectively seek academic excellence at higher education institutes. This book further encourages the higher education institutes' administrators to promote the use of innovative and new methods in teaching techniques that inspire learning by adapting to the necessities of the current data-based era and future practices. In so doing, this book is a perfect read for those who are interested in case study methods for higher education research and teaching because it aims to collect case studies of various approaches and teaching innovation methodologies through their application. In this way, the readers of this book could understand and apply these case studies and techniques developed in this current era. Moreover, this book will help the readers understand the implementation and adoption of innovative and latest techniques and methodological approaches that can benefit the future.

Chapter 1, in Section 1, discusses the latest technologies and learning techniques that become the cause of the further increase in innovative methodologies being applied in higher education. This

chapter further analyzes the most desired and innovative technologies in the educational system through a systemic literature review. Similarly, Chapter 2 contextualizes dichotomies in higher education and provides examples through various case studies. Exclusive examples of teaching innovation at the university level during the COVID-19 pandemic have been focused on so that the significance of innovation is explained to the readers in order to offer quality education. Moreover, Chapter 3 focuses on didactic strategies for meaningful learning, particularly to achieve learning goals at higher education levels. Students' centered approach to learning has been encouraged, where they can create their own understanding and assumption with confidence and freedom. It further concludes that didactic strategies, their design and implementation force meaningful learning with the help of active strategies in the meaningful learning process and didactic strategies depending on the context where they occur. The last (Chapter 4 in Section 1) highlights digital transformation and its impact on university teachers' strategies in the learning process. The major focus lies on social media and the content generated by the users as a teaching innovation tool at higher education institutes. In addition, this chapter provides details about the major platforms deployed in various educational setups so that it would become easy to understand how social media and its interaction tools promotes teaching innovation.

Chapters in Section 2 compile the key case studies to highlight the implementation of teaching innovation and its practices in different academic themes and subjects at higher education institutes. However, Section 2 is quite different in approach and delineation of teaching innovation and various processes through practice, e.g., student-centered teaching innovation model to improve pedagogy for undergraduate students. Chapter 5 presents shifting the ownership of the learning process from teacher to learners through an innovative technique named student-led instructor-facilitated guided-inquiry learning (SLIFGIL). Chapter 6 guides how new and innovative interdisciplinary methods work in higher educational institutes. The authors present a case study of Indiana University South Bend, where they linked the development of computational models and their relation to the concepts of uncertainty, quantum computing, and complexity. By doing so, they want to propose innovative teaching methods where information theory and innovation work side by side through an interdisciplinary approach. A case study in Chapter 10 proposes using hashtags on Twitter, a leading social media network, so that this new digital channel would be used to interact between teachers and learners to increase their engagement level. In Chapter 12, online exams and various digital technologies developed and applied in higher education institutes are studied. It further helps to understand how teachers can analyze the self-deception behavior among students during online learning and assessment processes. This part of the book is crucial for prospective teachers and practitioners to understand the variables that can influence the student's learning and assessment online in digital environments.

Moreover, this book can be used at any higher education level because it allows and guides practitioners to boost their knowledge, increase the quality of teaching innovation methodologies, and critically analyze and use the new innovations in education. This book helps the readers to understand five basic concepts about teaching innovation and different processes. First, the readers understand the central actions of teaching innovation at higher education institutes through case studies. Second, it helps to understand knowledge creation in relation to teaching innovation methodologies, techniques, and processes at universities. Third, it guides how to interact and explore utilizing new and innovative technologies at the universities. Fourth, it helps to identify the viewpoints of processes, teaching innovation, and their strategies. Finally, this book guides the future lines for advancing learning and teaching innovation and their practices in the higher education ecosystem.

For instance, in Section 1, Chapter 1 analyzes the primary methods the teaching innovation process uses in higher education ecosystems. It further highlights how active and reflective learning and the adaptability of these groups work in real learning and teaching contexts. Similarly, Chapter 2 provides systemic literature about the post-COVID-19 pandemic teaching innovation strategies and the advantages and disadvantages of these innovative ecosystems in higher education adopted after COVID-19. The last part of Section 1 deliberates primary teaching innovation techniques and

methodologies developed in higher education institutes and associated with social networks, the leading digital tools and their generated content linked with social networks, and finally, strategies and uses applied to the future of learning and teaching innovation.

Despite comprehensive discussion about teaching innovation, this book has a few shortcomings. This book should have a chapter about the comparative analysis between teaching innovative and traditional methods so that beginners can understand more easily the importance and vitality of these new techniques and methods. More case studies from Asian and lesser developed countries should also be added to encourage more diversity in this highly demanding topic. Keeping these suggestions aside, this book provides detailed and easy-to-understand instructions and examples for implementing teaching innovation methods for all levels of education. The methods and approaches to teaching innovation and case studies can help educators to advance their teaching and instruction models from a traditional to an advanced digital atmosphere. In so doing, the teachers can increase the quality of their methods for teaching innovation to use innovations and boost knowledge critically.

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